Digital Insurance Claim Management System

BUSINESS ANALYSIS CASE STUDY

Project Information

Field	Details
Project Name	Digital Insurance Claim Management System
Project Code	DICMS-2024
Document Type	Business Analysis Case Study
Department	Insurance - General & Health Insurance
Organization	Meridian Assurance Ltd.
Project Sponsor	Malcolm Young
Senior Business Analyst	Shreemudra Satapathy
Project Manager	Aditya Singh

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1.Executive Summary

The Digital Insurance Claim Management System (DICMS) was a business transformation initiative for Meridian Assurance Ltd., a mid-to-large insurance company processing approximately 40,000 claims per month across 14 cities. The initiative was undertaken to replace a largely manual, spreadsheet-driven claims process with a centralized digital platform covering the end-to-end claims lifecycle, including policy verification, claim submission, document management, fraud detection, approval, settlement, and reporting.

The solution was delivered using Agile Scrum over a nine-month period across six releases. The primary focus was to streamline claims processing, improve operational efficiency, strengthen fraud and compliance controls, and provide customers and management with better visibility into claim status and performance.

As the Business Analyst, I focused on understanding the existing claims process, identifying pain points and business gaps, engaging with stakeholders, defining requirements and business rules, and translating them into actionable user stories, acceptance criteria, process flows, and supporting BA artifacts.

The proposed solution targeted a reduction in average claim settlement time from approximately 16–18 days to 7–9 days for standard claims, while providing management with a consolidated view of claims across branches.

2. Project Overview

Project Name: Digital Insurance Claim Management System (DICMS)

Industry: Insurance - General & Health Insurance

Client: Meridian Assurance Ltd.

Project Duration: 9 months

Methodology: Agile (Scrum)

Role: Senior Business Analyst
Responsibilities:

- Requirement Gathering and Analysis
- BRD Preparation
- Stakeholder Management
- User Story Creation
- Process Flow Modelling
- UAT Planning and Coordination

3. Business Context

Meridian Assurance Ltd. is a mid-to-large insurance organization operating across 14 cities and processing approximately 40,000 claims each month. The claims function involves multiple stakeholders, including customers, claims teams, surveyors, underwriting, fraud and risk, compliance, finance, and customer service.

The existing claims process relied heavily on manual activities, spreadsheets, email communication, and document handling. As claim volumes increased, these fragmented processes created challenges in tracking claims, coordinating between teams, validating information, identifying potential fraud, and providing customers with timely updates.

The business therefore identified a need to move towards a centralized digital claims management platform that could support the complete claims lifecycle. The proposed solution would bring key activities such as claim intimation, validation, document management, assessment, approval, settlement, fraud checks, communication, and reporting into a more structured workflow.

From a business perspective, the initiative was focused not only on digitizing existing activities but also on improving the overall claims process. The key priorities were to reduce processing delays, minimize manual effort, strengthen controls, improve transparency, and provide better visibility into claims for both customers and management.

4. Business Problem

The existing claims process at Meridian Assurance Ltd. was largely manual and involved multiple handoffs between branches and different departments. Claims were received through branch counters or email and were then tracked using shared spreadsheets and physical documents. As a result, processing a claim often took 16–18 days, with limited visibility into the status of claims for customers.

The decentralized approach also created challenges for the business. Regional teams maintained their own tracking methods, making it difficult for management to get a consistent view of claim volumes, ageing, and potential fraud exposure across locations. There was also no systematic mechanism to identify suspicious claims before settlement.

From the customer perspective, delays and the lack of regular status updates were contributing to an increase in complaints. At the same time, compliance reviews identified recurring gaps in documentation and audit trails, creating additional operational and compliance concerns.

The business therefore needed a more centralized and structured claims process that could reduce manual effort and delays, improve claim visibility, strengthen fraud and compliance controls, and provide management with reliable information for monitoring and decision-making.

5. Business Objectives

The primary objective of the Digital Insurance Claim Management System is to **reduce claim settlement turnaround time and improve operational control** by moving away from manual, branch-level claim handling to a centralized digital process.

The solution is intended to:

- Enable faster and more consistent policy verification.
- Standardize claim intake and assessment across branches.
- Introduce rule-based fraud checks before claim approval.
- Give management a consolidated view of claim volumes, claim status, and ageing.
- Maintain a complete audit trail to support compliance and improve process transparency.

- Provide better information for timely and informed decision-making throughout the claims lifecycle.

Overall, the goal is to make the claims process faster, more consistent, transparent, and easier to manage across the organization.

6. Scope

I worked with Claims, IT, and Compliance stakeholders to clearly define the project boundaries and separate the capabilities planned for the current phase from enhancements that could be considered in future phases.

In Scope

The project included:

- An end-to-end digital claims process covering claim submission, document upload, verification, assessment, approval, settlement, and closure.
- Integration with the existing policy administration system to verify policy and coverage details.
- A configurable multi-level approval workflow based on factors such as claim type, claim value, and risk score.
- Rule-based fraud detection to identify potentially suspicious claims before payout.
- A customer-facing portal, along with the existing customer app, for claim submission and status tracking.
- Automated SMS, email, and app notifications at key stages of the claims journey.
- A centralized reporting and management dashboard to provide visibility across all branches.
- A phased rollout, starting with a pilot at two branches before extending the solution to all 14 branches.
- UAT, training, and change-management support for claims and branch staff.

Out of Scope

The following areas were excluded from the current phase:

- Underwriting and policy issuance, as these continued to be handled by existing systems. The new solution only integrated with these systems where required.

- Advanced AI/ML-based fraud analytics. The initial implementation focused on rule-based fraud detection, with AI/ML capabilities considered as a future enhancement.
- Reinsurance and third-party claim recovery processes.
- Migration of historical claims data older than 12 months.
- Development of a new iOS/Android mobile application, as the existing customer app was extended rather than rebuilt.
- Integration with external legal or litigation management systems.

7. Assumptions & Constraints

Assumptions

The following assumptions were considered while designing the proposed solution:

- Existing customer and policy information would be available to the new claims system.
- Customers would have access to a valid mobile number or email for notifications.
- Required claim documents could be uploaded digitally.
- Business teams would provide the necessary claims, eligibility, approval, and fraud-related rules.
- The existing payment process would be available for integration with the claims system.
- Relevant stakeholders from Claims, Compliance, Fraud/Risk, Operations, and IT would be available for requirement discussions and validation.
- Users would receive appropriate training before the system is introduced.
- The proposed solution would follow the organization's security, privacy, and compliance requirements.

Constraints

The project was considered within the following constraints:

- Integration with existing/legacy insurance systems could limit some functionality.
- Some historical claim data may require additional effort for migration or integration.
- Fraud detection rules may need to evolve as more claims data becomes available.
- The solution needs to comply with insurance, data privacy, and audit requirements.

- Availability of business and technical stakeholders could affect requirement validation and decision-making.
- Changes to existing business processes may require training and change management.
- The solution would depend on the availability and reliability of external services such as payment and notification systems.

These assumptions and constraints were considered during requirements analysis so that the proposed solution remained realistic and aligned with the existing business and technology environment.

8. Key Business Pain Points

Pain Point	Business Impact
Manual claim submission	Longer processing time
Paper-based/fragmented documents	Difficult tracking and verification
Multiple manual handoffs	Delays and processing errors
Limited claim visibility	More customer enquiries
Manual validation	Higher operational effort
Late fraud identification	Increased financial risk
Complex business rules	Requirement/process inconsistency
Compliance and audit challenges	Difficult traceability
Limited reporting visibility	Slower management decisions
High manual effort	Reduced operational efficiency

During the analysis, I identified that the main issue was not a single inefficient step, but the number of manual handoffs across the end-to-end claims process. This created delays, limited visibility, and increased operational effort. The proposed digital solution therefore focused on improving the complete claims journey rather than automating only one activity.

9. Stakeholder Analysis

This project involved two distinct stakeholder layers: organizational stakeholders, who shaped scope, priorities, governance, and sign-off during discovery and sprint activities; and system user roles, who interact directly with the platform and are represented through the user stories.

At the organizational level, Claims Operations, Fraud & Risk, Compliance, and Underwriting held significant influence over scope and process decisions. Their priorities required trade-off negotiation between operational efficiency, risk control, regulatory compliance, and appropriate claim assessment. IT/Technology shaped technical feasibility and integration requirements throughout the sprint cycle, while Finance and Regional Branch Managers were engaged in more focused, phase-specific activities.

At the system level, these organizational stakeholders translate into functional user roles. Claims Operations maps to the Claims Officer and Claims Manager roles; Fraud & Risk Management maps to the Fraud Investigation Team; Compliance & Legal maps to the Compliance Officer; Finance Department maps to the Finance Team; Underwriting maps to the Underwriter role; and Customer Service maps to the Call Centre Executive role.

Two system roles — Customer (Policyholder) and Surveyor/Loss Assessor — sit outside the internal organizational stakeholder structure because they represent external users who participate directly in the claim lifecycle.

The System Administrator is a technical/operational role aligned with the IT/Technology function and is responsible for system configuration, user access management, and integration monitoring.

The Insurance Agent role, while identified during the initial stakeholder analysis, was not onboarded to the digital platform in the current release. Agent-initiated claim submission and related functionality have therefore been deferred to a future phase.

This dual view — organizational stakeholders driving requirements, governance, and business decisions versus system roles interacting with the resulting workflows — ensures that both the business context of the project and its functional system design are clearly documented.

10. My Role as Business Analyst

As the Business Analyst, my role was to understand the existing insurance claims process, identify the key pain points, and work with business stakeholders to define a more efficient digital claims journey.

I worked with stakeholders from Claims Operations, Compliance, Fraud/Risk, Customer Service, IT, and other relevant teams to understand their needs, concerns, and expectations.

I analyzed the current claims process and identified areas where manual work, multiple handoffs, limited visibility, and document-related issues were causing delays. Based on this analysis, I helped define the future-state process for digital claim submission, validation, assessment, approval, settlement, tracking, and communication.

I gathered and analyzed requirements through stakeholder discussions and workshops, clarified business rules and exceptions, and converted the requirements into functional requirements, user stories, and acceptance criteria.

I also created process flows, maintained the Requirement Traceability Matrix, supported UAT preparation, and worked closely with the development and QA teams to clarify requirements throughout the delivery process.

One of my key responsibilities was to make sure that different stakeholder priorities were properly considered. For example, Claims Operations wanted faster processing, while Compliance and Fraud/Risk teams needed stronger controls. I helped bring these requirements together and translate them into clear business rules and workflow requirements.

Overall, my role was to act as the bridge between the business and technology teams and ensure that the proposed solution addressed the actual business problems while providing a better experience for customers and operational teams.

11. Requirement Elicitation Approach

For the Digital Insurance Claim Management System, I used a combination of stakeholder discussions, interviews, workshops, document analysis, and process analysis to understand the existing claims process and identify business requirements.

I first identified the key stakeholders involved in the claims lifecycle, including **Claims Operations, Underwriting, Compliance, Fraud/Risk, Customer Service, Finance, IT, and end customers**. I then conducted discussions with the relevant stakeholders to understand their responsibilities, pain points, business rules, and expectations from the proposed system.

I also reviewed the existing claims-related processes and documentation to understand how claims were currently being submitted, validated, assessed, approved, and settled. This helped me identify areas where manual activities, multiple handoffs, and limited visibility were creating delays or operational challenges.

During stakeholder discussions, I used **scenario-based questions** to understand not only the normal claim journey but also exception scenarios—for example, incomplete documentation, claims requiring additional review, potential fraud cases, rejected claims, and payment failures.

Where different stakeholders had competing priorities, I facilitated discussions to understand the underlying business need and helped reach an agreed approach. For example, **Claims Operations focused on faster processing, while Compliance and Fraud/Risk required stronger controls**. I captured these requirements as business rules and workflow requirements so that both operational efficiency and control requirements were addressed.

After gathering the information, I analysed and consolidated the requirements, validated them with the relevant stakeholders, and converted them into **functional requirements, business rules, user stories, acceptance criteria, and process flows**. I maintained traceability through the RTM and used UAT scenarios to ensure that the key business requirements could be validated during testing.

In simple terms, my approach was:

Stakeholder Identification → Interviews & Discussions → Document/Process Analysis → Identify Pain Points → Clarify Business Rules & Exceptions → Validate Requirements → Document Requirements → Traceability → UAT Validation

12. Gap Analysis

The analysis of the existing claims process identified several gaps that were affecting processing efficiency, customer experience, and operational visibility. The main gaps and the proposed improvements are summarized below.

Area	Claim Submission
Current State	Claims are initiated through branch visits, email, or other manual channels.
Gap Identified	Customers have limited digital self-service options.
Proposed Future State	Provide a digital claim-intimation facility through the customer portal/app.

Area	Document Handling
Current State	Documents are collected and exchanged manually.

Gap Identified	Documents can be delayed, misplaced, or require repeated follow-up.
Proposed Future State	Enable customers to upload required documents directly against the claim.

Area	Policy & Claim Validation
Current State	Validation involves manual checks across available information.
Gap Identified	Processing takes more time and increases the possibility of manual errors.
Proposed Future State	Integrate with the existing Policy Administration System and introduce validation rules.

Area	Claim Assessment
Current State	Surveyor assignment and assessment activities require manual coordination.
Gap Identified	Delays can occur in assigning and tracking assessments.
Proposed Future State	Introduce structured surveyor assignment and assessment workflow.

Area	Approval
Current State	Claims move through approval activities with manual coordination.
Gap Identified	Limited visibility into approval status and pending actions.
Proposed Future State	Implement configurable multi-level approval based on claim type, value, and risk.

Area	Fraud & Risk
Current State	Fraud indicators are identified using defined checks and manual investigation.
Gap Identified	Potentially suspicious claims may require additional effort to identify and investigate.
Proposed Future State	Introduce rule-based fraud flagging and investigation workflow.

Area	Customer Communication
Current State	Customers may need to contact support to understand claim status.
Gap Identified	Limited visibility creates additional customer-service enquiries.
Proposed Future State	Provide claim-status tracking and automated notifications at key milestones.

Area	Settlement & Payment
Current State	Settlement and payment involve separate operational activities.
Gap Identified	Limited end-to-end visibility of payment status.
Proposed Future State	Integrate settlement workflow with the payment process and maintain transaction references.

Area	Reporting
Current State	Management information requires consolidation of claim data.
Gap Identified	Limited real-time visibility of operational performance.
Proposed Future State	Provide centralized reporting and management dashboards.

Area	Audit & Compliance
Current State	Information and activities may be distributed across different processes.
Gap Identified	Difficulties in maintaining complete traceability.
Proposed Future State	Maintain an audit trail of significant claim activities and decisions.

The key gap was not simply the absence of a digital application. The larger issue was the lack of a connected, end-to-end claims workflow. Different activities such as claim submission, document collection, validation, assessment, approval, settlement, and customer communication were not sufficiently integrated.

The proposed solution therefore focused on creating a more structured digital claims journey, while also addressing the needs of Claims Operations, Compliance, and Fraud/Risk teams.

13. Key Requirements

The key requirements were identified based on the needs of customers, claims teams, operations, compliance, fraud/risk teams, and management.

The requirements were grouped into key functional areas covering the complete claims lifecycle, from claim intimation through validation, assessment, approval, settlement, and closure. In addition, the solution addressed fraud and risk management, customer communication, escalation, reporting, and administrative configuration.

1. Digital Claim Intimation

Customers should be able to initiate a claim digitally by providing the required policy and incident details. The system should validate the information and generate a unique claim reference number.

2. Claim Validation

The system should validate the submitted claim against applicable policy and business rules. It should also identify missing information or documents before the claim moves to the next stage.

3. Document Management

Customers and internal users should be able to upload, view, and manage documents required for claim processing. The system should maintain documents against the relevant claim for easy access and audit purposes.

4. Survey & Claim Assessment

The system should support assignment of a surveyor or assessor where required. The assessment details and supporting information should be captured against the claim to support the decision-making process.

5. Claim Review & Approval

Claims should follow a defined review and approval workflow. The system should support different approval levels based on applicable business rules, claim values, or risk conditions.

6. Fraud & Risk Identification

The system should identify claims that require additional fraud or risk review based on configurable rules and risk indicators. Potentially suspicious claims should be flagged for investigation rather than being processed automatically.

7. Claim Settlement & Payment

Once a claim is approved, the system should support settlement processing and payment initiation. The claim status should be updated throughout the settlement process.

8. Claim Tracking

Customers and authorized internal users should be able to track the current status of a claim and understand where it is in the claims lifecycle.

9. Communication & Notifications

The system should provide notifications for important claim events, such as claim submission, document requirements, assessment updates, approval/rejection, and settlement.

10. Escalation & Grievance Management

The system should support escalation of delayed or disputed claims and provide a structured way to manage customer grievances and queries.

11. Reporting & Management Information

The system should provide reporting and management information on claims, processing status, turnaround time, settlements, and other relevant operational indicators.

12. Administration & Configuration

Authorized administrators should be able to manage configurable business rules, workflows, user access, and relevant system settings without requiring changes to the core application.

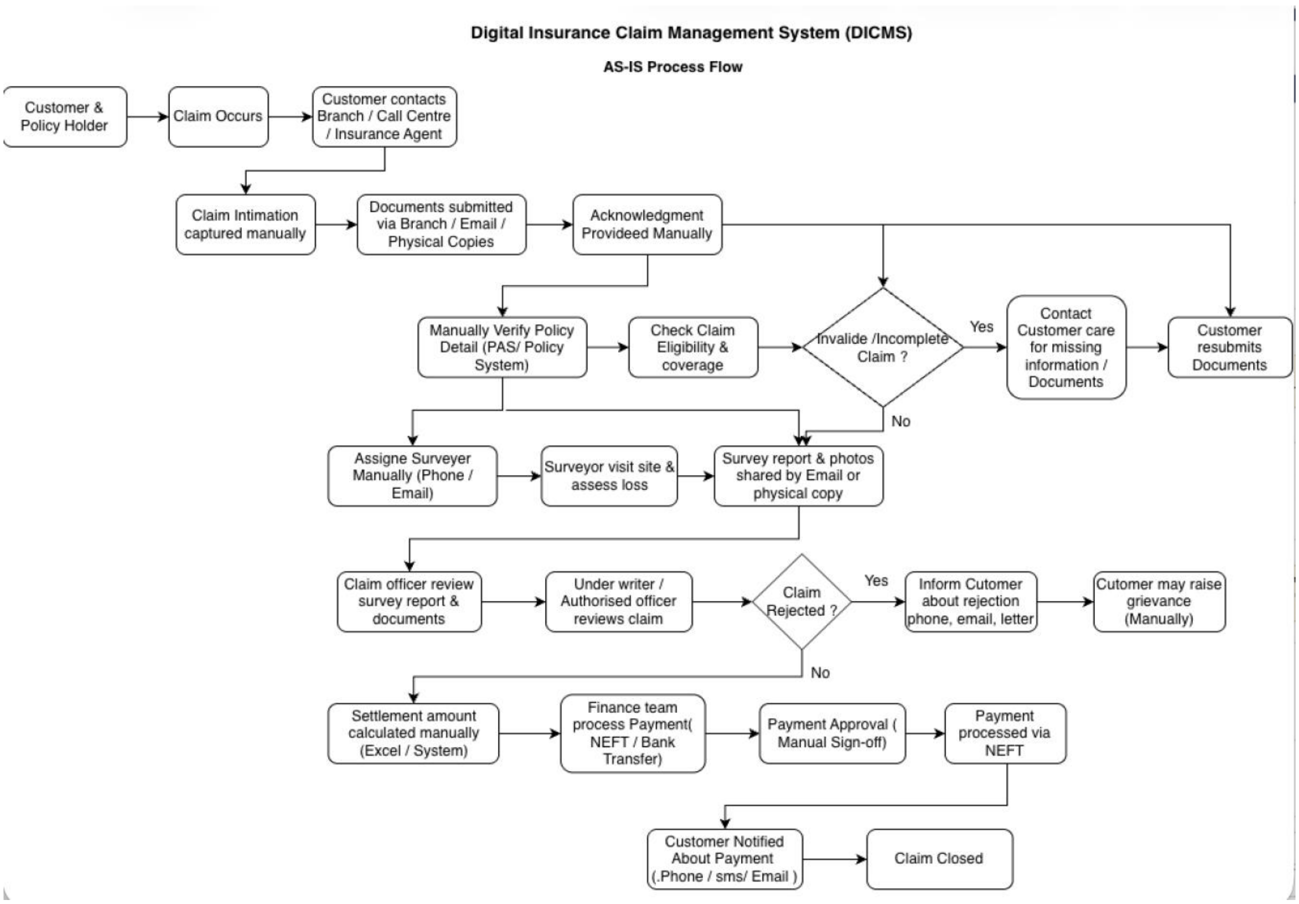
13. Fraud Investigation

Claims flagged as medium- or high-risk should be routed to a dedicated Fraud Investigation Team for structured review. The system should capture investigation findings, evidence reviewed, and a documented outcome before the claim is allowed to proceed to settlement or rejection.

14. Claim Rejection

The system should support formal rejection of a claim with a mandatory reason code and supporting justification, and should trigger customer notification and grievance-escalation options at the point of rejection.

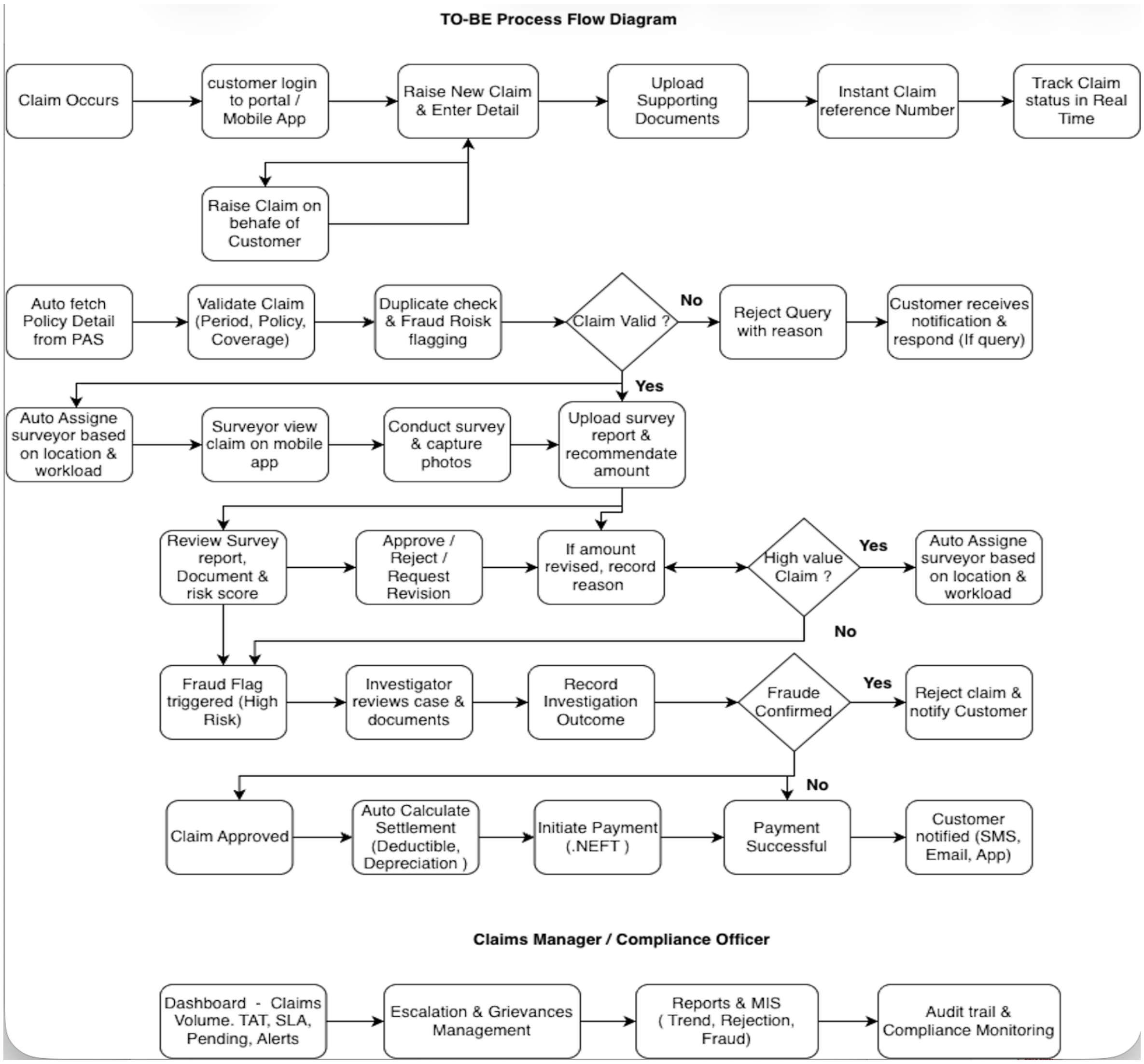
14. Process Flow



Key Pain Points Identified

- **Manual claim registration:** Customers often depend on branches, call centres, or agents to initiate claims.
- **Paper and email-based documentation:** Supporting documents are exchanged through physical copies, email, or multiple channels.

- **Manual policy verification:** Claims Officers manually verify policy coverage, validity, and eligibility.
- **Limited duplicate claim detection:** Potential duplicate or suspicious claims may not be identified early in the process.
- **Manual surveyor assignment:** Surveyor allocation depends on manual coordination and availability checks.
- **Delayed survey reporting:** Survey findings may be shared through email or physical documents, increasing processing time.
- **Multiple manual handoffs:** Claims move between Claims Officers, Surveyors, Underwriters, Finance, and other teams with limited workflow visibility.
- **Manual settlement calculations:** Deductibles and depreciation may require manual calculations, increasing the risk of errors.
- **Limited real-time claim tracking:** Customers may need to contact customer service for claim status updates.
- **Delayed communication:** Customers may not receive timely notifications about claim status changes or required documents.
- **Limited fraud and risk controls:** Fraud indicators may depend heavily on manual review and investigation.
- **High claim turnaround time:** Manual activities and multiple handoffs can contribute to delays in claim settlement.



Expected Improvements

- Digital claim intimation and document upload
- Automated policy validation
- Duplicate claim and fraud-risk flagging
- Structured surveyor assignment and digital assessment
- Role-based approval workflow
- Automated settlement calculations
- NEFT payment processing
- Real-time claim tracking
- Automated SMS/email notifications
- Digital query and grievance management
- Centralized reporting and audit trail

- Improved claim TAT and customer experience

15. Challenge & Solutions

Challenge 1: Real-time dependency on the Policy Administration System (PAS)

Field	Details
Challenge	DICMS needed live policy data (sum insured, coverage terms, validity) from PAS at the point of claim validation, but PAS was a legacy system not originally built for real-time external queries.
Impact	Claims officers risked validating claims against outdated or incomplete policy data, leading to incorrect approvals, rejected valid claims, or settlement disputes with customers.
Solution	Introduced a middleware integration layer with a fallback mechanism — if PAS was unreachable, the system allowed manual entry with a mandatory "PAS Reconciliation" flag, forcing a follow-up verification before final settlement.
Outcome	Claim validation continued without hard downtime dependency on PAS, while maintaining a controlled audit trail for any manually entered policy data, reducing settlement disputes.

Challenge 2: Balancing fast claim TAT with fraud detection needs

Field	Details
Challenge	Business stakeholders wanted faster claim turnaround time (TAT) to improve customer satisfaction, but the risk team insisted on thorough fraud checks before approval — two goals pulling in opposite directions.
Impact	Without a resolution, either fraud checks would be skipped under TAT pressure (increasing fraud exposure), or every claim would face manual scrutiny (defeating the purpose of digitization).
Solution	Designed a risk-based triage model — claims were auto-scored on submission using predefined fraud indicators (repeated claimant, inflated amount, location mismatch). Only "Medium" and "High" risk claims were routed for mandatory manual review; "Low" risk claims proceeded through the standard fast-track flow.
Outcome	Average TAT for low-risk claims improved significantly, while high-risk claims still received full scrutiny — satisfying both the customer experience and risk management objectives.

Challenge 3: Surveyor connectivity in remote/low-network areas

Field	Details

Challenge	Surveyors conducting site visits for claims (accident sites, rural properties) often worked in areas with poor or no internet connectivity, making real-time report submission unreliable.
Impact	Delayed survey report uploads directly stalled the claims pipeline, since underwriting couldn't proceed without the survey findings — creating a bottleneck at one of the most time-sensitive stages of the process.
Solution	Built offline-first capability into the surveyor mobile app — surveyors could fill in reports and capture photos offline, with the app auto-syncing to DICMS once connectivity was restored.
Outcome	Survey submissions were no longer blocked by network availability, keeping the claims pipeline moving even from remote locations.

Challenge 4: Conflicting claim amount recommendations (Surveyor vs Underwriter)

Field	**Details**
Challenge	Underwriters frequently revised the claim amount recommended by surveyors, but there was no structured way to capture why — leading to inconsistent decisions and difficulty defending settlements during audits or customer disputes.
Impact	Lack of a documented rationale created compliance risk (IRDAI audits) and weakened Meridian's position in case a customer challenged a reduced settlement.
Solution	Made "reason for revision" a mandatory field whenever an underwriter changed the surveyor's recommended amount, with both the original and revised values stored side-by-side in the claim's audit trail.
Outcome	Every amount revision became traceable and defensible, strengthening compliance posture and giving Meridian a clear paper trail for grievance or regulatory review.

Challenge 5: Customer document uploads failing due to format/size issues

Field	**Details**
Challenge	Customers frequently attempted to upload documents (photos, scanned bills) in inconsistent formats and sizes, especially from mobile devices, leading to failed submissions and support calls.
Impact	High document-upload failure rate meant delayed claim intimation and an increase in avoidable calls to customer support, adding operational cost.
Solution	Added client-side validation with clear, plain-language error messages (e.g., "File too large — please upload under 10 MB") and auto-compression for images exceeding size limits before upload.
Outcome	Upload failure rate dropped, and the number of support calls related to document submission issues reduced noticeably.

Challenge 6: NEFT payment failures disrupting settlement closure

Field	Details
Challenge	A portion of NEFT payment attempts failed due to incorrect or outdated bank account details on file, but the system had no clear recovery path — failed payments simply stalled without visibility.
Impact	Customers experienced payment delays without knowing why, and finance teams had no structured queue to identify and correct failed transactions, leading to escalations.
Solution	Introduced a dedicated "Payment Failed" status with auto-routing to the finance team's exception queue, along with a customer notification prompting them to verify/update bank details directly through the portal.
Outcome	Failed payments became visible and actionable immediately instead of going unnoticed, cutting down settlement closure delays and reducing escalations to customer support.

Challenge 7: Role-based access complexity across multiple stakeholder types

Field	Details
Challenge	DICMS had to serve ten distinct stakeholder types (customer, call centre executive, claims officer, surveyor, underwriter, finance team, claims manager, compliance officer, fraud investigation team, admin), each needing different levels of access to the same claim record.
Impact	Poorly defined access boundaries risked either over-exposing sensitive data (e.g., customer bank details visible to surveyors) or under-provisioning access (blocking legitimate actions), or under-provisioning access (e.g., fraud investigators lacking visibility into a claimant's prior claim history needed to assess repeat-claim risk), both of which would create security and usability issues.
Solution	Conducted a dedicated access-mapping workshop with stakeholders to define a role-permission matrix down to the field level (not just module level), then implemented role-based access control (RBAC) accordingly, configurable by admins without code changes.
Outcome	Each stakeholder saw exactly what their role required — no more, no less — improving both data security and day-to-day usability, while giving admins flexibility to adjust roles as the organization evolved.

16. Business Impact

1. Operational Efficiency

Impact Area: Claim processing turnaround time (TAT)

Before DICMS, claims moved through manual handoffs — paper forms, phone-based surveyor coordination, and email-based approvals — resulting in long processing cycles and limited visibility into where a claim was stuck.

With DICMS, claim intimation, survey assignment, underwriting, and settlement are tracked in one system with auto-routing and TAT alerts.

Expected Outcome: Reduce average claim settlement TAT from approximately 16–18 days to 7–9 days for standard claims.

2. Customer Experience

Impact Area: Self-service claim intimation and tracking

Previously, customers depended entirely on branch visits or phone calls to raise a claim and check its status, leading to frustration and repeated follow-up calls.

DICMS enables customers to raise claims, upload documents, and track status in real time through the portal, backed by automated SMS/email alerts at every stage.

Expected Outcome: Target a 30–40% reduction in claim-related support enquiries through self-service status tracking.

3. Fraud Risk Reduction

Impact Area: Early fraud detection at intake and structured investigation before resolution

Earlier, fraud indicators (duplicate claims, repeated claimants, inflated amounts) were often caught late — sometimes only during a manual audit — by which point payouts may have already been processed. Investigation, where it happened at all, was informal and undocumented.

DICMS auto-flags suspicious claims at submission using rule-based risk scoring, routing them for mandatory underwriter review before approval. Claims that remain flagged as high-risk are escalated to a dedicated Fraud Investigation Team, who review supporting evidence and record a documented investigation outcome before the claim is allowed to proceed to settlement or rejection.

Expected Outcome: Suspicious claims are now flagged before payout in 100% of cases matching defined fraud rules, compared to post-payout detection previously. High-risk claims additionally carry a documented investigation trail (outcome and recommendation logged per case) before resolution — closing the loop that was previously informal or unrecorded, and directly reducing potential fraudulent payout exposure.

4. Regulatory Compliance

Impact Area: Audit readiness and IRDAI compliance

Previously, reconstructing a claim's full history for a regulatory audit meant manually pulling records from multiple people and paper files — a slow, error-prone process.

DICMS logs every claim action (status change, document upload, amount revision, approval) with user ID and timestamp, and generates audit-ready reports on demand.

Expected Outcome: Audit report generation time reduced from several days of manual compilation to under 10 seconds for any given date range, improving Meridian's readiness for IRDAI inspections.

5. Cost Efficiency

Impact Area: Reduced manual and paper-based processing

Paper-heavy processes (physical document collection, manual data entry into multiple systems, printed reports) added both time and material cost per claim.

DICMS digitizes intake, survey submission, and reporting end-to-end, removing most paper dependency and manual re-entry.

Expected Outcome: Estimated 15–20% reduction in per-claim processing cost, driven by fewer manual touchpoints, reduced paper/logistics overhead, and lower call-centre load from self-service tracking (see Business Impact Area 2: Customer Experience).

6. Decision-Making & Management Visibility

Impact Area: Real-time MIS and performance reporting

Earlier, claims managers relied on periodic manual reports to understand claim volume, rejection trends, and TAT breaches — often reactive rather than proactive.

DICMS provides on-demand MIS dashboards showing claim volume, TAT breach risk, and rejection-reason breakdowns.

Expected Outcome: Claims managers can now identify TAT-risk claims and recurring rejection patterns in real time, enabling proactive intervention instead of after-the-fact analysis.

7. Scalability for Business Growth

Impact Area: Handling claim volume growth without proportional headcount increase

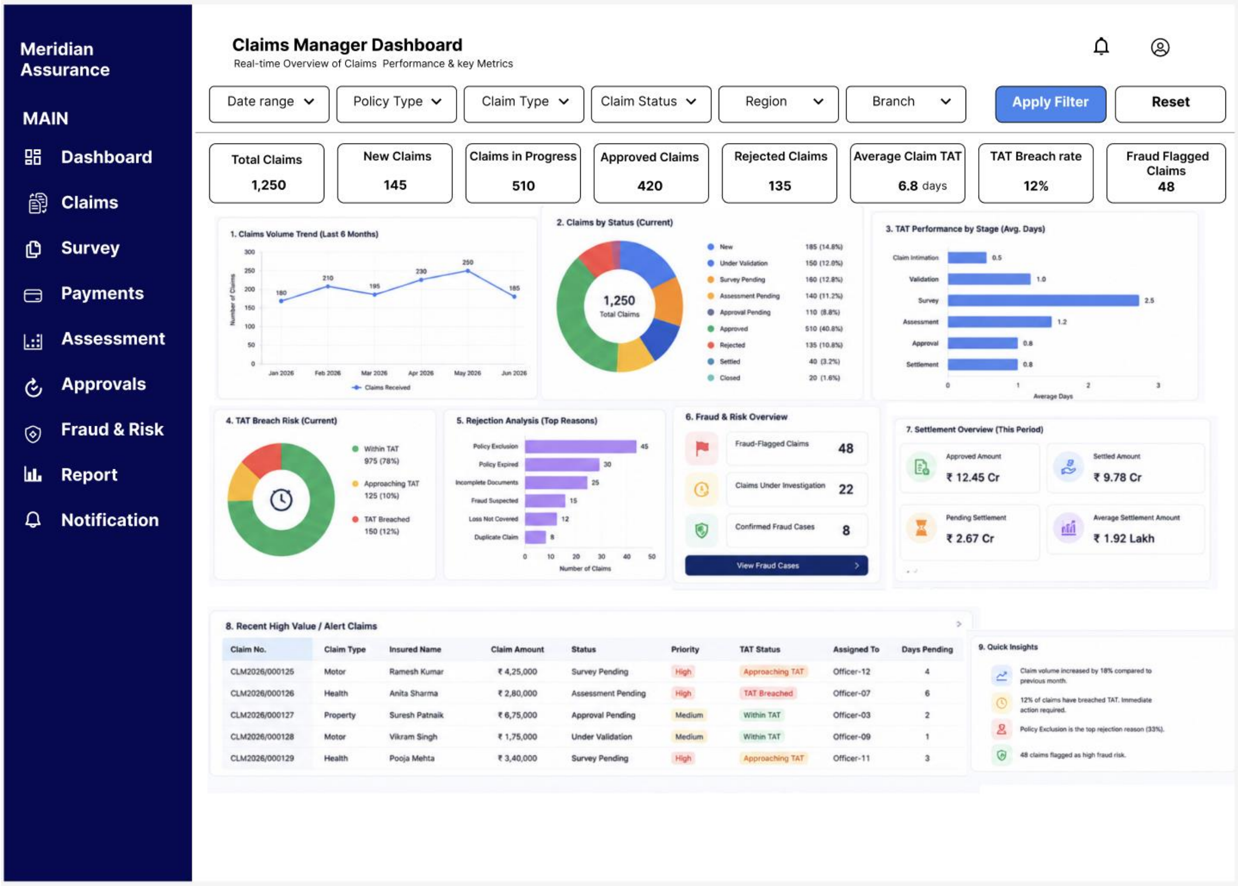
Manual processes meant claim-handling capacity was tightly linked to headcount — growth in policy base directly required more claims staff.

DICMS's modular, configurable architecture (business rules, TAT thresholds, and role permissions configurable without code changes) allows the system to absorb higher claim volumes with existing staff levels.

Expected Outcome: The proposed solution is designed to support approximately 30% year-on-year claim-volume growth without a proportional increase in claims-processing staff.

17. Claims Manager KPI Dashboard

Claim Manager KPI Dashboard



18. Business Analysis Techniques & Deliverables

Technique / Deliverable	Description	Used For
User Stories (Agile format)	Captured functional needs from each stakeholder's perspective	40 User Stories across 13 modules
Stakeholder Analysis / Power-Interest Grid	Mapped influence vs. interest to prioritize engagement effort	Stakeholder Analysis document
RACI-style Stakeholder Engagement Mapping	Documented how each org-level stakeholder was consulted, informed, or held decision authority during the project	Stakeholder Mapping Note

As-Is / To-Be Process Flow Diagrams	Visualized the manual process vs. the digitized DICMS workflow	Process flow diagrams
Cross-Functional Stakeholder Matrix	Showed which roles interact at which stage of the claim lifecycle	Stakeholder matrix
Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)	Linked each business requirement to its user story, acceptance criteria, test case, and UAT scenario	40-row RTM across 13 modules
Acceptance Criteria (Given-When-Then style)	Defined pass/fail conditions for each user story	Referenced per RTM row (AC-01a etc.)
UAT Test Scenarios	Validated business requirements and expected system behavior through UAT scenarios	UAT scenarios mapped to all 40 user stories
Functional & Non-Functional Requirements Documentation	Captured system behavior expectations and quality attributes (performance, RBAC, audit trail, scalability)	Requirements doc (NFR-03, NFR-05, NFR-10, NFR-11, NFR-13, NFR-19 referenced)
Wireframing	Visualized a key UI flow before development	Claim submission, claim tracking, claims officer dashboard, claim review & approval, and fraud investigation wireframes
Executive KPI Dashboards	Visualized claims performance, financials, fraud, and CX metrics for management reporting	Claims Manager KPI Dashboard and Digital Insurance Claim KPI Dashboard
Business Impact / Value Analysis	Quantified expected improvements across efficiency, cost, compliance, and risk	Quantified expected improvements across claim processing efficiency, turnaround time, customer experience, compliance, and fraud risk.
Scope & Gap Analysis	Identified and formally deferred an out-of-scope stakeholder (Insurance Agent) to a future phase	Stakeholder Mapping Note
Risk Identification & Analysis	Identified project and operational risks by category,	Risk Register (12 risks)

	likelihood, and impact, with mitigation and ownership	

Tools:

Representative enterprise BA toolset for a project of this type — Jira, Confluence, Figma, Excel, SQL, Power BI, MS Visio/Draw.io

19. Key Learnings

Working through this project strengthened my understanding of how a Business Analyst can bring structure to a complex business process. It reinforced the importance of understanding the current-state process before defining the future solution and of making business rules and exception scenarios explicit. I also learned that stakeholder alignment is critical when different teams have competing priorities, particularly across operations, compliance and fraud/risk. Finally, maintaining traceability from requirements through user stories, acceptance criteria and UAT helped ensure that the proposed solution remained aligned with the original business objectives.

20. Conclusion

The proposed Digital Insurance Claim Management System demonstrates how structured Business Analysis can transform a fragmented insurance claims process into a more centralized, transparent and controlled digital workflow.

The analysis addressed the complete claims lifecycle, from claim intimation and validation through assessment, approval, settlement, tracking and closure. It also considered supporting areas such as fraud and risk management, customer communication, escalation, reporting and administration.

A key part of the analysis was balancing competing stakeholder priorities. Claims Operations required faster processing, while Compliance and Fraud/Risk required stronger controls. These priorities were translated into configurable business rules, risk-based workflows, approval controls and audit requirements.

The proposed solution is expected to improve claims processing efficiency, customer visibility, fraud-risk management, compliance traceability and management reporting while providing a scalable foundation for future enhancements.